Derck Prinzhorn

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Experience

Exponential Security Labs, *Founding Member of Technical Staff* Jul 2026 – present
Build benchmarks and reinforcement-learning environments, and red-team AI agents.

Max Planck Institute for Intelligent Systems & ELLIS Institute Tübingen, *Research Intern* Jan – Aug 2026
Trained model organisms for AI control and compared activation-based white-box monitoring with text-based monitors.

Aithos Research Lab, *Research Engineer* Apr 2025 – Jan 2026
Conducted AI safety evaluations of LLM value systems and moral competence, testing decision consistency and responses to critical questioning.

Prinzhorn Solutions, *Founder* Apr 2025 – present
Advise small and medium-sized businesses on managing AI security risks.

Wisr, *Co-Founder* Sep 2024 – Oct 2025
Co-founded an education startup focused on AI-assisted grading and teacher feedback.

Dutch Police, *AI Architect* Apr 2023 – Apr 2025
Developed AI strategy and technical architectures for building and securing AI systems.

Education

University of Amsterdam Sep 2023 – 2026
MSc Artificial Intelligence Average: 8.0/10
Thesis: “Model Organisms for White-Box AI Control: Monitoring Internalised Misalignment”.

University of Amsterdam Sep 2020 – Jun 2023
BSc Artificial Intelligence Average: 8.2/10
Thesis: "Benchmarking Conformal Prediction Methods for Time Series Regression". Graduated cum laude.

Publications

LLM Agents Can Easily Tamper With Their Own Traces
J. Qin, D. Schmotz, **Derck Prinzhorn**, L. Beurer-Kellner, A. Prabhu, M. Andriushchenko.
arXiv, 2026.

Instrumental Monitor Evasion Emerges Under Ordinary Task Pressure
D. Schmotz*, **Derck Prinzhorn***, L. Beurer-Kellner, A. Paulus, A. Prabhu, M. Andriushchenko.
*arXiv, 2026. *Equal contribution.*

ResearchArena: Evaluating Sabotage and Monitoring in Automated AI R&D
L. Libon, B. Rank, J. Yeon, D. Schmotz, J. Qin, D. Donnelly, **Derck Prinzhorn**, M. Andriushchenko.
COLM Workshop on Agent Behavior, 2026.

Evaluating Newtonian Mechanics in Video Generative Models with Real Physical Systems
A. Tragoudaras, C. Zhang, D. Cherniavskii, A. Vozikis, T. Nijdam, **Derck Prinzhorn**, M. Bodracska, N. Sebe, A. Zadaianchuk, E. Gavves.
ICML, 2026.

Conformal Time Series Decomposition with Component-wise Exchangeability
Derck Prinzhorn*, T. Nijdam*, P. A. van der Linden, A. Timans.
*COPA / PMLR, 2024. *Equal contribution.*

Awards

AmsterdamAI Thesis Award — Outstanding bachelor thesis on conformal prediction for time series (2023).

Volunteering

Stichting Hoormij, Board Advisor & Quality Council — Jan 2021 – present
Forward Incubator, Startup Mentor — Dec 2024 – May 2025
AI Safety Amsterdam (AISA), Member — Sep 2023 – May 2025
Dutch Nao Team, ML Engineer & Vice Chair — Sep 2022 – Mar 2024
Programme Committee AI, UvA, Student Member — Sep 2021 – Apr 2023
Stichting Studiezalen, Mentor — Feb 2020 – Oct 2021
School's cool Amsterdam, Mentor — Oct 2020 – Aug 2021